

Garmin Coach — Coaching Integrity Check

An independent review of how your coach decides what to tell you · 10 July 2026

The short version

Your app was checked, thoroughly and independently, to answer one question: **is it built to give you the right call, or the call you want to hear?**

The answer is **yes — it holds the line**. It is built to be honest with you, not to flatter you, and the evidence backs that up. Overall grade: **B+** — strong foundations, with a couple of areas being made sharper.

Across your last 22 mornings it called **11 Green, 9 Amber and 2 Red**. It tells you to ease off when the numbers say so — on roughly half your days. This is not a machine that just says "go."

How it was checked

Three ways, so this is evidence rather than opinion:

1. **The decision code was read line by line** — the exact rules that turn your overnight data into a Green, Amber or Red.
2. **It was stress-tested with dozens of invented scenarios**, including deliberate attempts to sneak a hard day past it — feeding it poor nights, missing data, and "I feel great" check-ins to see whether any of them could force an easy Green it hadn't earned.
3. **It was cross-checked against your real history** — your actual morning verdicts and the write-ups that went with them.

Why you can trust it

The traffic light is maths, not mood. Your Green / Amber / Red is worked out by fixed rules from your numbers first. The AI then writes the explanation around that result — it can describe the day, but it cannot change the colour. You can't talk it into a better verdict.

It can't be gamed. Your Garmin figures — HRV, readiness, sleep, heart rate — come straight from your watch and can't be hand-edited. And your morning check-in can only ever make the day *more* cautious, never less. Telling it you feel great can't turn an Amber into a Green.

It's genuinely on your side about rest. An honest "I feel rough" only ever eases the day — it is never used to justify pushing harder. The one thing this app is built to resist is talking you into training when you shouldn't.

It judges your sleep fairly for your age. Rather than holding you to a 25-year-old's targets, it compares your sleep against what is healthy for your age band, using published sleep science. It will never pretend a bad night was a good one.

The plan itself is well-built. Proper build-and-recover cycles with a genuine easier week every third week, sensible interval sessions, and an FTP that only moves up when you've actually earned it on the

bike — not on a fixed schedule.

And your real write-ups back this up. On every one of your recent Amber and Red mornings, the write-up led with the honest call — "poor night", "below the threshold needed for a full-intensity day" — and never softened it toward training.

Where it's getting sharper

No tool is finished, and honesty cuts both ways. Four things are being improved. None of them mean the app is currently misleading you — they are about making a good coach even better, especially at catching the slow, creeping kind of overtraining.

Weigh the ramp, not just last night. Today's call is judged mostly on how you slept and recovered overnight. The next step is to factor in how hard you've been building over the past few weeks, so a fast ramp can prompt caution on its own — the classic way an athlete does too much, too soon.

Keep "normal" honest. The app learns your personal normal from your recent history. The improvement is to anchor that, so a rough few weeks can't quietly lower the bar for what counts as a good day.

Let tough days add up. At the moment, several middling signals on the same day still land as a single Amber. They should be able to stack into a full rest day when enough of them line up.

Turn warnings into action. When your recovery markers drift over several weeks, the app should ease the plan off automatically, rather than only flagging it.

The bottom line

This was a review, not a change — nothing about your plan or your app was altered. The headline stands: **the app is built to be straight with you, it can't be talked or typed into an easy answer, and on your real history it has held that line.** The improvements above are about spotting the slower, sneakier kind of overtraining — the kind that creeps up over weeks — even earlier than it already does.